

William N. Powell III (Liam)

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EDUCATION

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Aug. 2025 – May 2027

Master of Public Health, Global Health Concentration

Chapel Hill, NC

- Global Health Concentration Cohort Representative, 2025–26

Duke University & Duke Kunshan University

Aug. 2021 – May 2025

B.A., Interdisciplinary Studies (Global Health & Public Policy), Duke University

Durham, NC

B.S., Global Health & Public Policy, Duke Kunshan University

Kunshan, China

- Stanback Fellow | Public Policy Student Fellow | Fubon Scholar | 1st Place, HackDKU 2025 (Healthcare/Biotech Track)

EXPERIENCE

The Water Institute at UNC

Sept. 2025 – May 2026; Aug. 2026 – Present

Graduate Work-Study Student, Communities of Practice

Chapel Hill, NC

- Coordinated end-to-end webinar production for two global professional communities (1,000+ members across 50+ countries), managing stakeholder outreach, communications campaigns, event logistics, and technical deliverables; increased average WASH HCF webinar attendance by 50%
- Helped launch and build the Circuit Riders Community of Practice: launched washcircuitriders.org on UNC-hosted WordPress, grew the subscriber base from 0 to 297, and established a bimonthly webinar series

Hanoi Medical University – Center for Research and Training on Substance Use-HIV

June – July 2026

MPH Practicum Intern, Global Health

Hanoi, Vietnam

- Estimated ~750 person-years of PrEP coverage lost following the 2025 PEPFAR/CDC funding transition, designing and executing an interrupted time-series analysis of seven years of clinic records; estimated post-transition declines of 57% in service visits, 61% in medication dispensing, and 65% in new PrEP initiations
- Wrote the analysis pipeline in R from raw REDCap exports, reconstructing the clinic's existing Stata reporting definitions and excluding a concurrent research cohort that would otherwise have masked the post-transition decline
- Presented findings to clinic leadership and U.S. CDC staff in Hanoi; delivered a findings memo, a reproducible analysis repository with an automated audit script, and the first written data dictionary for a clinic database that had none

FHI 360

May – Aug. 2024

Stanback Fellow, Research and Knowledge Management – WASH

Durham, NC

- Developed resources for the Just Ask microlearning initiative and wrote a ChatGPT-assisted drafting procedure with citation verification and technical review steps
- Developed Global Handwashing Day campaign materials and reviewed a hand-hygiene research summary for clarity and accurate interpretation of findings

United States Agency for International Development

May – Aug. 2023

Student Trainee, Bureau for Global Health – Office of HIV/AIDS (OHA)

Washington, DC

- Conducted compliance reviews for \$2M+ in HIV/AIDS subawards across 20+ country teams to ensure alignment with PEPFAR policies and USG regulations
- Coordinated technical inputs for Country Operational Plans and key population programming under EpiC

PROJECTS & RESEARCH

BRFSS Insights, UNC Gillings AI and Public Health Datathon

Spring 2026 – Present

Front-End Design and Deployment | Most Creative Solution, Team Red

Chapel Hill, NC

- Designed and built the participant-facing survey flow and front end for a diabetes risk estimation tool (logistic regression on CDC BRFSS data), deploying the full-stack Node.js prototype to Vercel
- Presented the prototype to NC DHHS leadership, leading to a proposed UNC–NC DHHS collaboration to develop and validate a refined public-health application based on the model; MOU and project scope are currently under review

Signature Work Thesis, Duke Kunshan University

Feb. 2024 - Mar. 2025

Bridging the Divide: Global Health and International Development Policy Priorities in the Trump and Biden Eras

- Analyzed 2,300+ USAID documents using machine learning-assisted topic modeling, finding disease-specific bilateral programming dominant under Trump and multilateral engagement and reproductive health expanding under Biden

SKILLS

Technical & Analytical: R, Python, Stata, REDCap, BERTopic, Dedoose, Qualtrics

Methods: Interrupted time-series and quasi-experimental design, predictive modeling, topic modeling

Languages: English (Fluent), Mandarin Chinese (Intermediate)